

3D was paused for evidence reasons, not because geometry is irrelevant

Geometry quality is a real lever



What the result means

Sampling more ETKDG conformers removes only about one fifth of the geometry gap.

Decision boundary

Use ETKDG consistently for the current production contract; revisit relaxed geometries only when a new compute budget exists.

Scope caveat: this lever was measured on the QM9 architecture screen, not on PubChemQC.